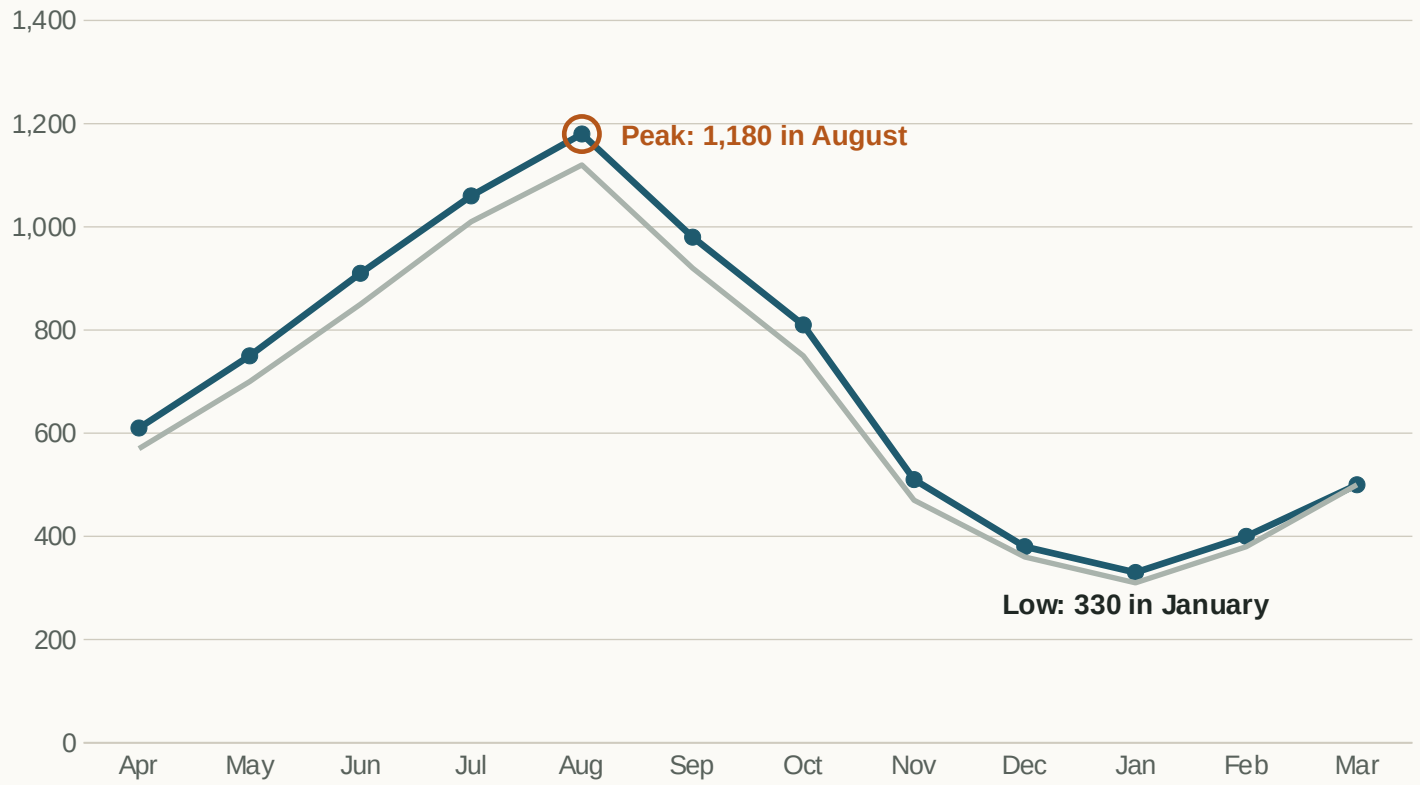
1

VISITORS AND ACCESS

Visits rose 6.0% to 8.42 million, and more than a third of visitors now arrive without a car

Visits each month, thousands: **this year, 2025-26**, and **last year, 2024-25**



How visitors arrived

Share of visits	2024-25	2025-26	Change
Car	71%	64%	-7 pts
Bus, shuttle or train	**19%**	**25%**	**+6 pts**
On foot or by bike	10%	11%	+1 pt

Step-free trails

241 km of trail can now be used without steps by wheelchairs and buggies, 53 km more than last year.

School visits

41,300 pupils came on free school trips.

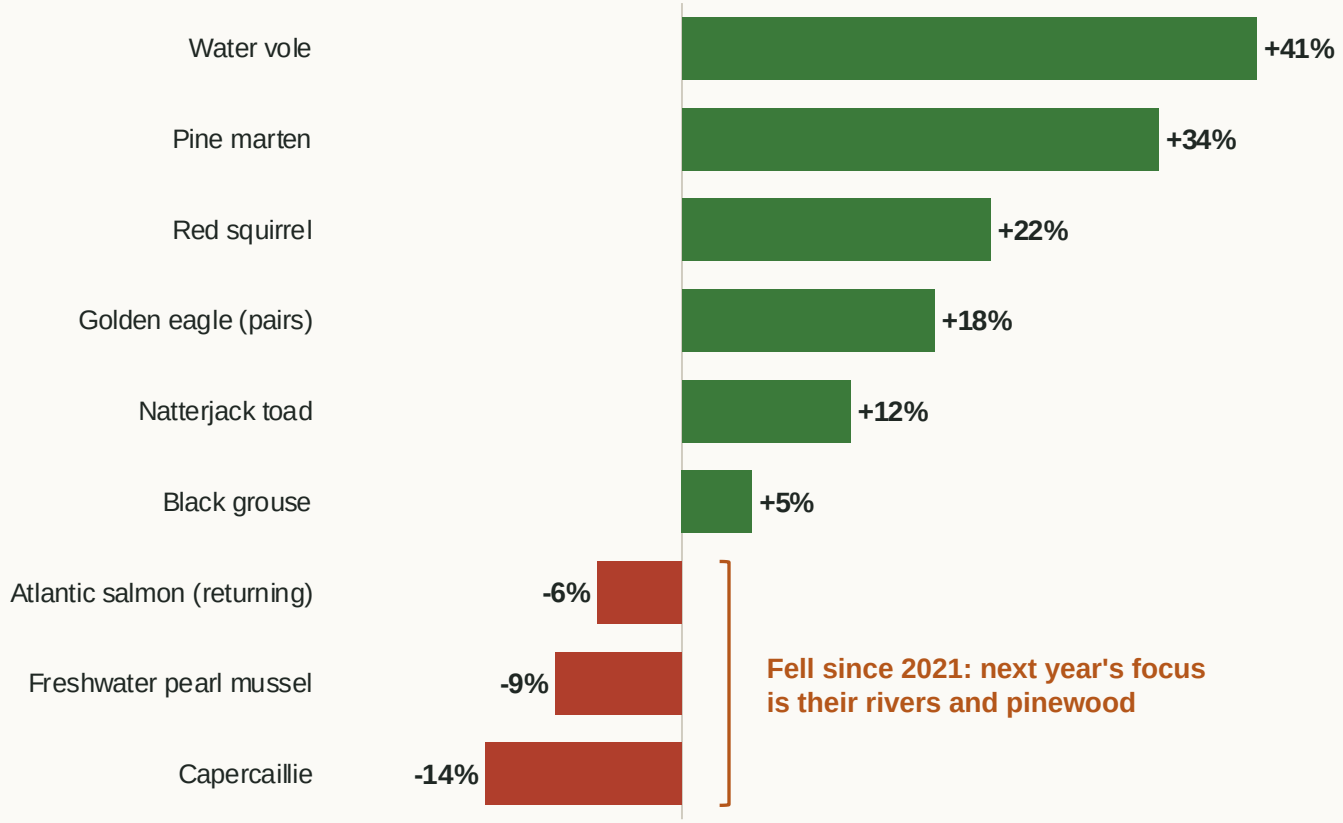
Visits are counted at park entrances; how visitors arrived comes from our visitor survey. Source: Brannoch National Parks Service records, April 2025 to March 2026. Illustrative figures for a fictional service.

2

CONSERVATION OUTCOMES

Six of nine priority species have grown since 2021; three that need rivers or old pinewood have fallen

Change in each species' counted population since the 2021 count, %



Habitat restored this year

We restored **2,140 hectares**, 107% of our 2,000 target.

Habitat work	Hectares	Share
Peatland re-wetted	1,260	59%
Native woodland planted	540	25%
Wetland restored	340	16%
Total	**2,140**	**100%**

Why three species fell

Salmon and pearl mussels need cool, clean rivers; warmer summers and silt from eroding banks harm both. Capercaillie are disturbed by walkers leaving the path in old pinewood.

Species are counted by rangers and volunteers each spring against the 2021 baseline count. Source: Brannoch National Parks Service records, April 2025 to March 2026. Illustrative figures for a fictional service.

3

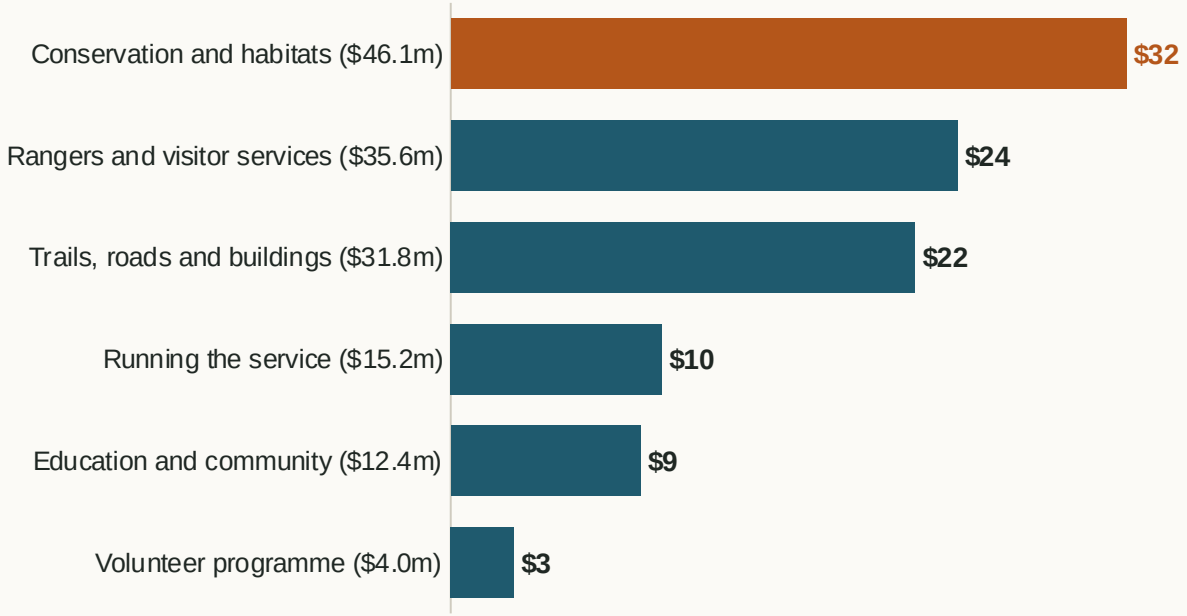
BUDGET AND WHERE IT GOES

Of every $100 we spent, $32 went to conservation and $10 to running the service

We received $148.3m, 5.3% more than last year, and spent $145.1m. The $3.2m left over is set aside for repairs. The government grant paid 65% of our income; visitors, shops, donors and trusts gave the other $51.9m.

Where each $100 went

Dollars of every $100 spent in 2025-26; the area's spending in $m after its name



Where the money came from

Income, $m

Source	2024-25	2025-26
Government grant	94.0	96.4
Parking, camping and permits	25.9	28.7
Shops, cafes and leases	10.6	11.2
Donations and legacies	6.8	7.9
Grants from trusts	3.5	4.1
Total income	**140.8**	**148.3**

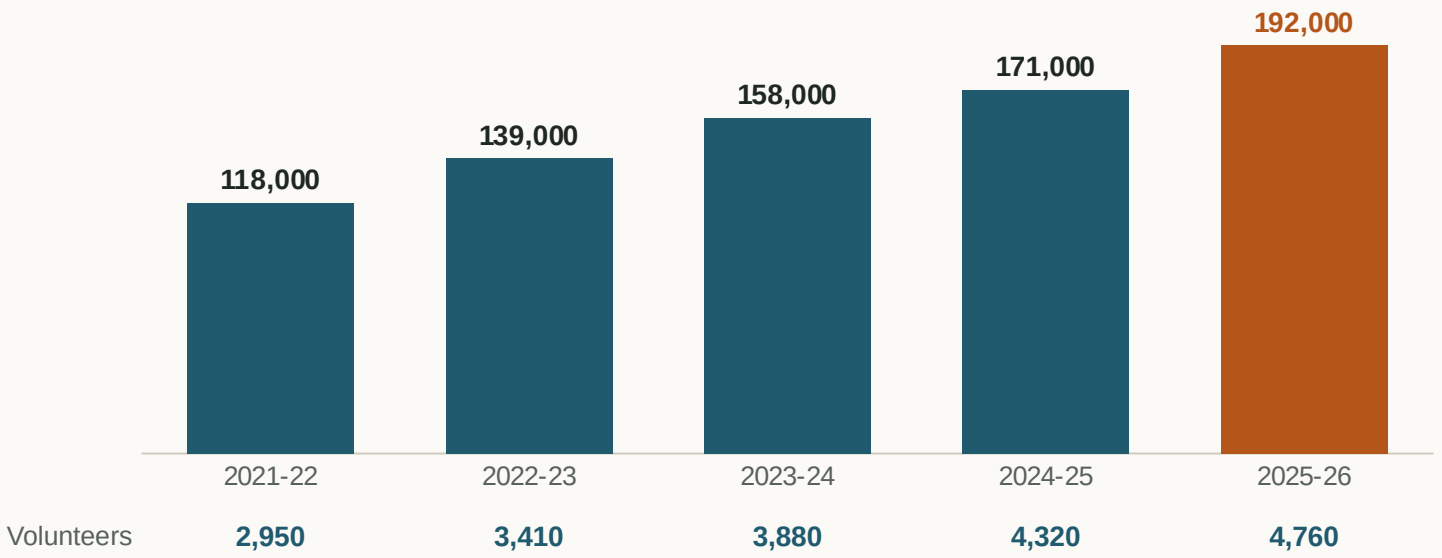
Spending shares are rounded so that they add to $100. Source: Brannoch National Parks Service records, April 2025 to March 2026. Illustrative figures for a fictional service.

4

VOLUNTEER PROGRAMME

Volunteers gave 192,000 hours this year, up 63% in four years

Volunteer hours each year, with the number of volunteers under each year



What the work is worth

At $24.50 an hour, this year's hours are worth $4.70m: $1.18 of work for every $1 the programme cost us ($4.0m).

That is the work of 116 full-time staff, given by 4,760 people.

$24.50 is the average hourly cost of a seasonal ranger; a full-time year is 1,650 hours.

More people, not longer hours

Each volunteer gave about 40 hours a year in all five years, between 39.6 and 40.8 hours, so the 63% rise in hours came from the 61% rise in volunteers.

What volunteers did in 2025-26

74,000
hours of habitat work

48,000
hours repairing trails

39,000
hours welcoming and guiding visitors

21,000
hours of wildlife surveys

10,000
hours of litter clean-ups

Hours are logged by volunteers and checked by their team leaders. Source: Brannoch National Parks Service records, April 2025 to March 2026. Illustrative figures for a fictional service.

5

PRIORITIES FOR NEXT YEAR

Five commitments for 2026-27, costing $13.6m, each with a measure we will report next year

Each commitment answers a finding on the pages before. Hold us to the measures: next year's report will say whether we met each one.

Commitment	What we will do	How you will know, by March 2027	Budget ($m)
1 Healthier rivers	Replant 18 km of riverbank with native trees and fence it from grazing, to cool and clean the water for salmon and mussels	**18 km planted; silt and summer water temperature measured at 12 river sites**	3.4
2 Getting here without a car	Run three new shuttle routes from rail stations and towns, with one ticket for the bus and entry	**30% of visits by bus, shuttle or train, up from 25%**	2.6
3 Step-free trails	Resurface and widen trails so wheelchairs, buggies and walking frames can use them	**281 km of step-free trail, up from 241 km**	1.9
4 Repairs we have put off	Fix bridges, toilets and paths on our list of 214 priority repairs, worst first	**60 of the 214 repairs done (28%)**	4.8
5 More and younger volunteers	Start a scheme for 16 to 25 year olds and add weekend and evening sessions	**5,300 volunteers, up from 4,760**	0.9
Total			**13.6**

Budgets are from the 2026-27 spending plan approved by the Service's board. Source: Brannoch National Parks Service records, April 2025 to March 2026. Illustrative figures for a fictional service.